also found that there was a large parcel of land, promised to the city by the former Prime Minister, Indira Gandhi, which could provide an immediate solution to the city's space problems.

This area, which I called the PortLands, measures about 1,000 acres in the heart of our city. It was freed up when the operations of the Mumbai Port moved to JNPT across the harbour. Instead of making this space available to the city as directed by Indira Gandhi (a directive which was subsequently ratified by the Ministry of Environment), it was being misused.

Shipbreaking, a highly toxic and polluting activity, was carried out without any environmental safeguards at Darukhana, a mere 5 km from the Chief Minister's office, the Mantralaya. This became the graveyard even for India's iconic aircraft carrier, the *Vikrant*. Over two million tonnes of coal were dumped and stored annually in the adjoining area of Haji Bandar. The coal dust from these coal mountains had been polluting the lungs of the city for over 10 years. As a result, the leading causes of death in Mumbai in 2014 were respiratory illnesses such as lung cancer, tuberculosis, asthma and emphysema. Appeals from the local Koli fishermen and other residents of the area to stop these activities had fallen on deaf ears for many years – ignored by the Port Trust, the Maharashtra Pollution Control Board and every political party.

I believed that reclaiming Mumbai's PortLands could be the key to the rejuvenation of our city. Polluting activities had to be stopped and the area redeveloped to provide the much needed social infrastructure and public amenities that the people of Mumbai were starved of: schools, colleges, hospitals, parks, sea-facing promenades, sports, arts and cultural centres, entrepreneurial incubation hubs and more.

During this time, I was invited by the US Secretary of State, Hillary Clinton, as the Indian representative on her International Council on Women's Business Leadership (ICWBL). Since 2011, I have been privileged to work and interact with secretary Clinton and many other